



WEIRD *but wonderful*



I look much better in the dark!

Viperfish

This fearsome fish has sharp teeth like glassy needles that stick out from its jaw. In fact, they protrude so far that it has to open its jaw really wide to get food inside. The viperfish also has a devious trick to catch its prey: it has a light-emitting organ called a photophore on its top fin, which it uses to lure fish toward its jaws.



Slime molds

If you see a jelly-like mass moving slowly across your lawn, it's probably a slime mold. Slime molds are protists. When the time's right for a cellular slime mold to reproduce, the individual slug-like cells glue themselves together to form a single mass and live as one. Some of the cells form the fruiting body, while others become spores.

I NEED TO KEEP MY COOL—IF I GET TOO HOT, I MIGHT JUST FALL APART!

Venus flytrap

Lurking in boggy conditions is this fly-eating plant called a Venus flytrap. Its leaves are hinged into two lobes colored red to attract insects. When an insect touches the sensitive hairs inside the lobes, the plant snaps shut trapping it inside. Then enzymes get to work, digesting the prey while it's still alive.

